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Culture (OWC): [San \(FX10\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Southern Africa

Field Date: 1958-1966

Coverage Date: 1958-1966

Place Coverage: G/Wi, Ghanzi District, Botswana

Section Title(S): Social Control

The potential for conflict within the band is minimized by a number of factors. G/wi cosmology encourages a stoical acceptance of much misfortune as coming from a capricious and largely indifferent deity. N!adima, the creator, may act simply because he feels so inclined. He may “grow tired of your face” and visit some catastrophe on an individual or even kill him or her. Drought, the disappearance of migratory herds of antelope in the season when they are usually present, disease, and accident may be attributed to his inscrutable wish to hurt, rather than to the enmity of one individual for another.

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Ingroup Antagonisms

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Community Structure

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General Character Of Religion

Band territory and unexploited resources are not susceptible to individual ownership and thus occasion no disputes. Dwindling resources are not a cause of conflict, as the band either moves to a fresh campsite or splits up into household groups long before resources become so depleted that people would have to compete for them. The association of plant food with marriage restricts conflict over this commodity to the confines of the household. The obligation to share the majority of other possessions virtually defines theft out of existence and restricts conflict over these possessions to the kinship frame of reference.

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Real Property

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Social Relationships And Groups

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Ingroup Antagonisms

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Community Structure

Abhorrence of any violence that goes further than the domestic exchange [175](#) of blows effectively prevents assaults. The latitude permitted among joking partners leaves no real possibility that mutual insults could lead to any more than retaliation in the same coin. As I have mentioned, the restricted

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Ethics

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Ingroup Antagonisms

nature of interaction between avoidance relatives effectively prevents direct conflict between them.

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Kin Relationships

Human Relations Area Files

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